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**GEN 1.3 ENTRY, TRANSIT AND DEPARTURE OF PASSENGERS AND CREW**

**1. Customs requirements**

- 1.1 Baggage or articles belonging to disembarking passengers and crew are immediately released except for those selected for inspection by the customs authorities. Such baggage will be cleared on the basis of an oral declaration except in the case of returning citizens.
- 1.2 Baggage Declaration Form, which is distributed while on flight, must be duly accomplished upon arrival and should be presented to the Customs Officer.
- 1.3 Baggage or articles belonging to tourists or transients are promptly released, except if the owners desire to have them placed in bond under the Customs custody.
- 1.4 No customs formalities are normally required on departure.

**2. Immigration requirements**

**2.1 Entry requirements**

- 2.1.1 Any person entering the Republic of the Philippines for the purpose of immigration must hold a valid passport and an immigration visa, the latter being issued at the Philippine consulates abroad. Temporary visitors must be in possession of a valid passport, with the exception of the following from whom existing official documents of identity, such as expired passports, national registration cards or alien resident permits, are acceptable in lieu of a valid passport:
  - a. Laissez Passer, issued by the United Nations;
  - b. Seaman Discharge Book holder, issued to a left behind crew member seeking entry for the purpose of rejoining his vessel in the Philippines;
  - c. Other travel document showing their origin and identity, issued by authority of authorized Officials;
  - d. Certificate of Exemption from Passport Requirements, issued by authority of the President of the Philippines.
- 2.1.2 For tourists, passport must be valid for at least six (6) months beyond the authorized period of stay in the Philippines.
- 2.1.3 For other non-immigrants, passport must be valid six (6) months period of authorized period of stay in the Philippines.
- 2.1.4 Visas are required, except for the following:
  - a. Aliens in direct transit to a foreign destination on the same or connecting flight and staying at the airport transit area.
  - b. Left behind merchant seaman seeking entry for the purpose of rejoining their vessels in the Philippines with prior request by the shipping agent or the master and with approval of the same by the Immigration Commissioner.
  - c. Holder of valid Special Return Certificates and Valid Permit to Re-enter.
  - d. Alien children born subsequent to the issuance of Immigration Visa of the accompanying parent, the visa not having expired.
  - e. Bonafide tourists coming for not over 21 days under Executive Order 408 and properly documented for admission into the country with valid return or onward ticket to next port of destination which is required for presentation upon arrival at the airport.

NOTE: Under this provision, privileges shall not be extended to nationals or citizens of following States (must have valid entry visa upon arrival);

- i. Nationals of the following countries:  
Afghanistan, Albania, Algeria, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Belize, Bosnia-Herzegovina, Cambodia, China, Egypt, Estonia, Former Yugoslav Republic of Macedonia (FYROM), Georgia, India, Iran, Iraq, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Latvia, Lebanon, Libya, Lithuania, Moldova, Nigeria, North Korea (Democratic People's Republic of Korea), Pakistan, Russian Federation, Sierra Leone, Sudan, Syria, Tajikistan, Tonga, Turkmenistan, Ukraine, Uzbekistan, and Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (Serbia and Montenegro Peoples Republic of Croatia (PROC)), Cuba, Laos, Slovenia, and Vietnam (regular passport holders only: diplomatic and official passport holder does not need entry visas).
- ii. The following are also required entry visas when coming to the Philippines:  
Holders of Taiwanese passports, Holders of Documents of Identity (DI), Certificates of Identity (CI) or Travel Documents (Titre de Voyage), Stateless Persons.
- iii. The following nationals are allowed to enter the Philippines without a visa for a stay not exceeding seven (7) days:  
Holders of Hong Kong-British, British National Overseas (BNO), Special Administrative Region (SAR) passports, holders of Portuguese passports issued in Macao.

Important Notes:

1. For admission without visas, regulations require that passports are valid for at least six (6) months. However, Immigration Officers at ports of entry may exercise their discretion to admit holders of passports valid for at least sixty (60) days beyond the intended period of stay;  
  
For admission with visa, passports must be valid for at least six (6) months, unless entry is otherwise authorized by the Department of Justice or the Bureau of Immigration.
  2. Valid ticket for return journey to port of origin or to the next port of destination is required for presentation upon arrival at the airport.
  3. Nationals who are subjects of deportation/blacklist orders of the Department of Justice and the Bureau of Immigration shall not be admitted to the Philippines.
- f. Countries with which the Philippines has agreements on the abolition of visa requirements for holders of Diplomatic, Official, or Special Passport for the duration of assignment or mission in the Philippines which are as follows:
- Austria, Bolivia, Brazil, Brunei, Chile, Croatia (FSC 230-94), Cuba, Denmark, Finland, Germany, Greece, Hungary (FSC 189-94), Indonesia, Israel, Italy, Republic of Korea, Laos (FSC 227-96), Malaysia, Norway, Panama (FSC 198-97), Peru (FSC 106-97), Poland, Romania (FSC 203-96), Singapore, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Thailand, Tunisia, Venezuela and Vietnam (FSC 36-97).
- g. Nationals of the following countries, if coming as temporary visitors (up to 59 days stay). Countries with which the Philippines has agreements for the abolition of visa requirements (for holders of regular passports and entry for business or pleasure):
- Brazil, Brunei, Gibraltar, Indonesia, Israel, Malaysia, Romania, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Thailand and Mongolia (FSC 164-94).
- h. Those waived by the President of the Philippines under the following category:

- i. Children below 15 years of age, unaccompanied by or not coming to join a parent, may be allowed entry into the Philippines, unless the Immigration Commissioner waives the exclusion ground against them, as provided in Section 29 (a) of the Philippine Immigration Act of 1940 as amended, and payment of Immigration fees of Php 860.00.
- ii. Alien seaman coming to the Philippines to join their vessels for the first time must be in possession of valid visas, irrespective of whether or not they are nationals of those countries having bilateral agreements with the Republic of the Philippines regarding no visa requirements.

2.1.5 The Standard ICAO Embarkation/Disembarkation (E/D) Card, which is distributed by airline crew, must be duly accomplished and must be presented upon arrival/departure to the Immigration Officer.

## **2.2 Departure requirements**

2.2.1 Embarking passengers must satisfy the following requirements:

- a. Valid passports;
- b. Embarkation Card;
- c. Boarding Pass;
- d. Emigration Clearance Certificate (ECC). ECC are not required for:
  1. Foreign government officials and dependents admitted under Section 9 (e).
  2. Naval personnel of foreign government-owned vessels of war.
  3. Alien seaman admitted temporarily and solely in pursuit of their calling as seaman, if leaving within 30 days. An alien seaman allowed to pay off or discharge in the Philippines may either be under escort from date of pay off or discharge or required to present Certificate of Exemption.
  4. Tourists admitted under Executive Order No. 408, if leaving within 21 days.
  5. Temporary visitors admitted under Section 9 (a), if leaving within 59 days from the date of arrival.
  6. Transients admitted under Section 9 (b), if leaving within 59 days from the date of arrival.
  7. Foreign personnel of regional or area headquarters of multinational companies, and their qualified dependents as defined in Presidential Decree (PD) No. 218 (amended by Executive Order No. 226, Book III, Art. 59).
  8. Alien admitted under Letter of Instruction (LOI) No. 105 of the President of the Philippines (Balikbayan), if leaving within one (1) year from date of arrival.

2.2.2 For persons that fall under this provision in subsection 2.2.1 d (5) and (6), if leaving after their authorized stay of 59 days shall be subject to payment of visa, waiver fee of Php 400.00, and a legal research fee of Php 10.00 will be required. Those who stayed beyond 59 days will be treated as temporary visitors under subsection 2.2.1 d (5).

2.2.3 For persons that fall under this provision in subsection 2.2.1 d (5) and (6), if leaving after 59 days but within 6 months from date of entry, the proof of payment of the following immigration fees will serve as ECC (not applicable to restricted nationals):

- Visa fee of Php 450.00

- Head tax of Php 200.00, who stayed more than 59 days and is above 16 years of age.
- Extension fee of Php 200.00, for every month or fraction thereof.
- Alien Certificate of Registration fee of Php 400.00 for 14 years of age and above; Php 150.00 for below 14 years of age.
- Emigration Clearance Certificate fee of Php 500.00, for 14 years of age and above.
- Certificate of Exemption fee of Php 100.00, for below 14 years of age.
- Legal Research fee of Php 10.00, in addition to each item above, except for the Head Tax.

2.2.4 For those not exempted from payment of immigration fees, a regular ECC is required.

NOTE: Regular ECC are required, although they stayed for less than 59 days from entry.

- For other non-immigrants like Treaty Traders, Students, and Pre-arranged employees.
- For restricted nationals, additional requirements maybe required, if their admission into the country was subjected to the posting of cash bonds.

### 2.3 Transit requirements

2.3.1 No document or visa is required of passengers arriving and departing on the same through flight or transferring to another flight at the same or a nearby airport provided and who do not leave the transit lounge or Airport Direct Transit Area of the airport.

2.3.2 Transfers to hotels in emergency cases, upon written request, may be allowed. Should there be restricted nationals, Immigration escorts will be required, with prior request and approval by the Immigration authorities.

2.3.3 In transit passengers with connecting flights on the same day should be clearly indicated in both the incoming and outgoing passengers' manifest.

### 2.4 Crew requirements

2.4.1 Aircraft crew members leaving the airport for a layover must individually clear with the Immigration Officer on Duty by presenting their passports with the General Declaration of the flight.

2.4.2 Upon departure for foreign country, the same procedure will be required.

2.4.3 Flight crew members and other technical personnel may be allowed entry into the Philippines as passengers without visas, provided there is a notice in advance of the same, and provided further that their coming is urgently required for the purpose of converting to an airworthy condition any aircraft which, for technical reasons, is unable to continue its journey, or that they are joining an aircraft already in the Philippines.

| 2.4.4 Member crew certificate provided in ICAO Annex 9, Appendix 7, may in meritorious cases, be recognized.

### 3. Public health requirements

3.1 Any commander of an aircraft to be inspected for quarantine shall give to the Quarantine Medical Officer on duty all information required from the health part of the aircraft General Declaration, and sign for the authenticity of this information.

3.2 The inspection of disembarking passengers and crew shall be performed in the quarantine inspection area at the airport terminal.

- 3.3 A Yellow Fever Vaccination Certificate is required from travellers over one (1) year of age arriving within six (6) days from infected areas.

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